



Mainstream laptop

Your daily driver

A good mainstream laptop is a quintessential tool to help you navigate this modern, digital age. It needs to be portable enough, powerful, and good-looking enough to fulfil all your work and entertainment-related needs. The mainstream laptop represents the ideal computer that an employee receives on their first day of joining, a school-going child gets for scoring good marks in an exam, and something that every aspirational individual needs to fulfil their dreams in this digital era. You won't regret getting any of these laptops.

Winner: Lenovo Ideapad Slim 5i

The Lenovo Ideapad Slim 5i impressed us with its simplicity. The mainstream laptop trumped its competitors in terms of processing, display, and battery performance. The Lenovo Ideapad Slim 5i comes with an 11th Gen Intel Core i5-1135G7 processor featuring 4 cores and 8 threads along with a 4.20 GHz of Turbo boost frequency. The powerful Intel chip gets paired with 8 GB of DDR4 RAM and a 256 GB SSD. To ensure that you don't run out of space, the laptop also features a 1 TB HDD as well. Be it office applications or streaming Netflix, the Lenovo Ideapad Slim 5i can handle both for an entire workday thanks to more than 8 hours of uninterrupted battery life (in a mixed usage scenario) that it provides.

In terms of synthetic benchmarks, the laptop scored 2132 in Cinebench R20, which is a good score in its category. Furthermore, in the Cinebench R23 benchmark the laptop scored 5478 and 1353 in multi-core and single-core performance tests. These scores put it ahead of all of its competitors.

The 14-inch FHD display scored more than 300 nits of peak screen brightness and relatively higher colour accuracy when compared to its counterparts during our Calman display tests. Lastly, such a well-performing laptop comes in a chassis built to withstand your daily commute, vacation, or anything in between.



Lenovo Ideapad Slim 5i

Price:
₹69,899



Runner Up and Best Buy: Acer Aspire 5

The Acer Aspire 5 delivers on its promise of being a great all-rounder laptop with the help of a capable processor, commendable battery life, and a good fit and finish. The laptop was a tough competitor to the Lenovo Ideapad Slim 5i on the performance front but was ultimately outmatched by the ultra-high battery life its competitor provides. This mainstream laptop comes equipped with a 512GB SSD and according to Crystal Disk Mark 8, it has a read and write speed of 1989 MB/s and 981 MB/s respectively. Furthermore, the laptop comes equipped with Intel Iris Xe graphics which scored 2972 in 3D Mark's Firestrike test and 1209 in Time Spy synthetic benchmark.

In the Cinebench R20, the Intel chip powering the laptop scored 2000. On the other hand, in the Cinebench R23, the chip scored 4997 as a multicore score and 1263 as a single-core score. During day to day productivity tasks, this laptop worked very well and maintained a peak surface temperature of 40.6°C.

In terms of display performance, the laptop has 265 nits of peak brightness and it covers 63.5% of the sRGB colour space, 46.9% of DCI P3 colour spectrum and 47.1% of the Adobe RGB colour space.

During our battery test, the laptop delivered 6 hours and 28 mins of continuous battery life, which is good for a laptop in this category. You can easily expect more than 6 hours of uninterrupted battery life on performance mode.

The laptop also won our hearts thanks to its thin-bezel display and a relatively light kerb weight of just 1.65 kg, thus scoring the second position and the best buy title in the mainstream laptop category.

– Yetnesh Dubey | yetnesh@digit.in



Acer Aspire 5

Price: ₹51,390